



THE CONGRESS-NCP ALLIANCE IS LOOKING FORWARD TO A HAT-TRICK IN THE ASSEMBLY

It's not just the Dalits and the farmers who are agitating. Parties like the PWP and the SP have united to provide an alternative to those who do not wish to vote for the leading parties. Says Abu Asim Azmi, senior SP leader in Maharashtra: "The Third Front may not get a majority but we will get enough seats to be in a bargaining position with the leading formation."

The going, however, is not all that good with ideological cracks appearing weeks before polls. On one hand, the parties focusing on the religious minorities feel that the saffron alliance is a bigger untouchable, while those representing the farmers believe that the Congress-NCP combine is a bigger evil. Clearly, the Third Front has laid out the task for the next government, even if it does not dent the power equation in the state. ■



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